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‘Barotseland agreement resurfaces’

....as Mundubile pledges to reopen dialogue on the 1964 treaty with BRE once elected

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Man prefers death over cuffs

By Ruth Kambita

A 25-year-old man of Namwala District has been hospitalized under police guard after allegedly raping his 17-year-old cousin and attempting to take his own life to evade arrest.

The incident occurred on August 3 at about 21:00 hours when the victim reportedly went to bed and at about 04:00 hours the following morning the suspect entered her room and raped her by force.

Southern Province Police Commanding Officer Moono Namalongo who confirmed the incident said the victim was rescued after the suspect's 23-year-old sister heard her shouting for help.

Mr Namalongo said the victim was issued a medical report form and a docket has been opened.

He said Police later traced and apprehended the suspect and at the time of arrest he had locked himself in a house and was suspected to have ingested an unknown poisonous substance.

Mr Namalongo said the suspect is currently receiving treatment at Namwala District Hospital under police guard.

"The Zambia Police Service strongly condemns all forms of sexual violence and assures the public that every effort will be made to ensure that the perpetrator is brought to justice," Mr Namalongo said.



NRPUP presidential candidate Brian Mundubile conveys with one of BRE traditional

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Real News in Real Time

Ballots land on the C/belt tomorrow

By Luyando Mukuka

Copperbelt Province is expected to receive ballot papers tomorrow, Thursday, August 6, as the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) continues distributing election materials ahead of next week's General Election.

ECZ Corporate Affairs Manager Patricia Luhanga confirmed that the ballot papers will arrive at Simon Mwansa Kapwepwe International Airport in Ndola tomorrow afternoon.

Ms Luhanga said the Commission prioritized the distribution of ballot papers to peri-urban and remote parts of the country before dispatching them to urban areas.

She said Copperbelt Province is among the provinces scheduled to receive the ballot papers on Thursday after Lusaka and Central provinces.

She disclosed that the Commission has so far completed 52 percent of the distribution exercise, with 19 percent of the ballot papers currently in transit, while the remaining 29 percent is scheduled for delivery on Thursday, August 6.

Ms Luhanga has urged stakeholders in the Copperbelt Province to be physically present at Simon Mwansa Kapwepwe International Airport when the ballot papers arrive.

Zambians will head to the polls on Thursday, August 13, 2026, to elect the President and their local leadership representatives.

CEOs warn against political violence

By Ruth Kambita

A coalition of civil society organisations has condemned rising incidents of violence ahead of the 13 August 2026 General Election, warning that the attacks are undermining voter confidence and the credibility of the vote.

In a joint statement issued by Chapter One Foundation Josiah Kalala on behalf of nine organisations, the groups called for prompt and impartial investigations by the police, the National Prosecution Authority and the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ), saying violence, intimidation and obstruction of lawful electoral observation cannot be tolerated.

Mr Kalala cited video footage that appears to show people dressed in United Party for National Development (UPND) regalia blocking opposition representatives from observing the arrival of ballot papers.

He also referred to foot-

age showing an attack on an aspiring Independent Member of Parliament for Mwembezhi East, where individuals armed with machetes allegedly disrupted a political rally and threatened participants.

Mr Kalala further raised concern over reported violence in Western Province yesterday, in which suspected UPND cadres were said to have ambushed and stoned a campaign convoy carrying Brian Mundubile and Makebi Zulu.

"Violence harms more than those caught in the

immediate confrontation. It frightens voters, silences candidates, endangers journalists and election monitors, and discourages citizens from participating freely," he said.

Mr Kalala urged the Zambia Police Service to identify and arrest all persons against whom sufficient evidence exists, regardless of political affiliation, while calling on the ECZ to investigate possible breaches of the Electoral Code of Conduct and impose lawful sanctions where necessary.

He also appealed to

President Hakainde Hichilema, political parties and all Zambians to move beyond condemnation and take concrete action to stop election-related violence.

The CSOs include Chapter One Foundation, CARITAS Zambia, LCK Freedom Foundation, PANOS Institute Southern Africa, Alliance for Community Action, Transparency International-Zambia, Zambia Council for Social Development, Jesuit Centre for Theological Reflection and Advocates for Democratic Governance Zambia.

Lusaka man's stolen Hilux ride ended

By Ruth Kambita

A 27-year-old man from Garden Compound in Lusaka has been apprehended after police intercepted a Toyota Hilux believed to have been stolen in Namibia and driven into Zambia.

The vehicle was hired from Eyakulo Car Rental in Namibia by a Namibian national on July 29, 2026, and later reported

stolen. Tracking information indicated the vehicle had crossed into Zambia and was headed from Kazungula towards Livingstone.

Southern Province Police Commanding Officer Moono Namalongo said Police, together with Lemmy Zambwe of Livingstone District who reported the case, intercepted the Hilux at the Department of National Parks and Wildlife gate.

The vehicle carried registration number CAF 2438 ZM,

which officers suspect is a fake plate.

Mr Namalongo said the vehicle was impounded and the driver, identified as Mbiliyaya Daka, was detained and is in police custody and during a search of the vehicle, officers recovered documents relating to the car-hire agreement between Eyakulo Car Rental and the hirer.

He said investigations are ongoing, and further updates will be provided as the matter develops.

Choma thieves steal hammer mill

By Ruth Kambita

Unknown individuals have broken into a milling shop in Choma District, Southern Province making away with a hammer mill valued at K63,000 belonging to Francis Chuumpa.

It is alleged that on August 2, 2026, at about 19:00 hours, Mr Chuumpa's employee, who operates the hammer mill, knocked off duty after locking the building and leaving everything in place.

However, when the employee returned for work on August 3, 2026, at about 06:00 hours, he found the building broken into and the hammer mill missing. He later informed his employer.

Southern Province Police

Commanding Officer Moono Namalongo said police officers visited the scene and observed that the hammer mill had been removed by unscrewing and demounting it from its stand.

Mr Namalongo added that police also observed motor vehicle tyre marks a few metres from the front of the building, suggesting that a vehicle may have been used to transport the stolen property.

He said no suspect has been identified at this stage, adding that investigations were underway and efforts to trace the culprits and recover the stolen property were ongoing.

Mr Namalongo urged members of the public with information that could assist investigations to report to the nearest police station.

Findlay detained, family worries of his health

By Alex Maboshe

The family of businessman Harry Findlay who was detained yesterday has raised concerns over his health issues.

The faamily said despite him being detained yesterday, the businessman has not been formally charged with any offence yet.

In a statement issued today, the family said it respects the rule of law and has confidence in the legal process.

However, it expressed concern about Mr Findlay's health, noting that authorities have received medical reports detailing his serious condition, as well as repeated requests for the release of his passport so he can travel for urgent specialised treatment.

The family appealed for his medical needs to be given urgent and compassionate consideration in accordance with the Constitution and the law.

It also stressed that Mr Findlay is entitled to the presumption of innocence and called for his rights to be protected throughout any legal process.

The family further urged the public and the media to avoid speculation, allow the matter to proceed through the courts, and respect their privacy during what it described as a difficult time.

Police Public Relations Officer Godfrey Chilabi confirmed the arrest in an interview with the Real Times Digital Newspaper, stating that further information regarding the arrest will be communicated soon.

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‘Barotseland agreement resurfaces’

By Alex Maboshe

National Reconciliation Party for Unity and Prosperity (NRPUP) presidential candidate Brian Mundubile has pledged to hold dialogue with the Barotse Royal Establishment on the 1964 Barotseland Agreement if elected president next week.

Speaking at Limulunga Pal-

ace in Mongu, Western Province, during a meeting with the Kuta and traditional leaders this morning, Mundubile said the long-standing national question continues to undermine unity and weigh heavily on the country's conscience.

He stated that his administration would engage the Barotse Royal Establishment within a mutually agreed framework to

resolve the matter with dignity and fairness, in the spirit of "One Zambia, One Nation."

Mundubile also committed to decriminalising public discussion of the 1964 Agreement, insisting that no citizen should be arrested solely for raising the Barotseland question.

He further expressed concern that Western Province has consistently recorded the high-

est poverty levels and lowest development indicators in Zambia, a situation he attributed to prolonged marginalisation and underinvestment by successive governments.

If elected, his party would address this through a dedicated Marshall Plan for the province, developed in consultation with the Barotse Royal Establishment, religious leaders, civil

society and government institutions.

The Barotse Royal Establishment, through Right Honourable Ngambela Mukela Manyando, welcomed Mundubile's commitment to dialogue.

The Ngambela noted that a lack of understanding surrounding the Agreement has created unnecessary friction both in the region and across the country.

Zambia's Oscars Committee reconstituted

By Alex Maboshe

The Zambia Oscars Committee has been reconstituted under the administration of The Film Engine Zambia, with submissions now open for the 99th Academy Awards International Feature Film category.

Committee Chairperson Lawrence Thompson and Permanent Secretary in the Ministry of Youth, Sport and Arts Mr Kangwa Chileshe announced the development at a Press briefing at Secrets Cafe in Lusaka.

Mr. Thompson said the committee was established in 2021 by the Filmmakers Guild of Zambia and the SOTAMBE Film Institute, recognised by the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences, and formally launched by the ministry in 2022.

"Today marks another exciting chapter as the administration of the Committee is now being coordinated by The Film Engine Zambia," he said.

"We are excited about this new phase and the opportunities it presents to strengthen the Oscar submission process while upholding independence, transparency and professionalism."

He thanked previous members and introduced the new team which includes Chairperson Lawrence Thompson himself, Administrator Martina Mwanza SOTAMBE / Film Engine and members Christopher Puts, Berry Lwando, Milika Malindima, Misiche Chikungu (NAC), Grace Rumsey, Tau M'Yaveli (NAMA), Morgan Mbuo (NAMA) and Vice Chairperson Tivo Shikapwashya.

Mr. Thompson urged filmmakers to carefully follow Academy eligibility rules and the committee's submission guidelines.

Mr Chileshe described the reconstitution as a strategic milestone for Zambia's creative industries.

"Today's event is about ensuring that Zambian stories are seen, heard, celebrated and invested in by audiences around the world," he said.

He linked the move to Zambia's recent engagements at the Cannes Film Festival, which helped attract partners to the Africa Creative Market 2026 and the Creative Industries Business Summit in Lusaka.

Film, he noted, creates jobs, attracts investment, promotes tourism and exports culture.

"Zambia is no longer waiting to be discovered. Zambia is actively taking its place within the global creative economy," he said, urging filmmakers to tell stories that only Zambia can tell.

Thompson expressed anticipation for strong submissions to represent Zambia at the 99th Academy Awards.

Puma Energy launches loyalty App

By Ruth Kambita

Puma Energy has this evening launched Puma PRIS, Zambia's first fully integrated multi-tier loyalty app in the fuel sector, allowing customers to earn points on fuel, lubricants and shop purchases at the company's service stations.

The app — available on Android and iOS — is currently live at 72 of Puma's 76 sites, with nationwide rollout to follow.

Speaking at the launch, Zambia Chamber of Commerce and Industry president Anthony Kabaghe hailed the programme as a sign of private-sector support for the government's digital transformation agenda. Mr Kabaghe said the platform demonstrates how innovation and investment can improve customer experience, boost digital inclusion and contribute to economic growth.

Puma PRIS replaces paper-based reward schemes with a digital system that credits points instantly after eligible transactions and displays balances in real time. Customers can redeem points across Puma's network and participating partners for groceries, airtime, meals and fuel discounts. The app also offers tiered rewards, a spending tracker and consumption analytics to help users monitor purchases.

Puma Energy Zambia General Manager Zwelithini Mlotshwa described the launch as part of the company's commitment to simplify everyday transactions and support the wider adoption of digitally enabled commerce.

"The launch of Puma PRIS reflects our commitment to using digital innovation to enhance the customer experience," Mr Mlotshwa said.

Retail manager Wongani Vinkhumbo said the scheme was developed from customer feedback to make visits to Puma stations "more rewarding."

The programme aims to deepen customer loyalty, encourage cashless transactions and align the petroleum retail sector with Zambia's broader digital economy objectives.



FNB Zambia ink MoU with FQM

By Ruth Kambita

FNB Zambia and First Quantum Minerals (FQM) have today signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to expand access to finance for Zambian businesses seeking opportunities under the mining sector's Local Content Regulations.

The partnership will see FNB Zambia provide tailored working-capital and trade finance solutions to qualifying local

suppliers awarded procurement orders by FQM.

The initiative aims to strengthen local supply chains, unlock growth for Zambian enterprises and support sustainable economic development.

Speaking at the signing ceremony, Kabanda Lilanda, FNB Zambia Business and Commercial Banking Executive, said the bank was committed to supporting local enterprise development and inclusive economic growth.

"Access to finance should never be a barrier to business growth and participation in key sectors of the economy," Mr Lilanda said.

"Through this partnership with First Quantum Minerals, we are creating a pathway for local businesses to access the funding they need to seize opportunities within the mining value chain, grow their operations and contribute meaningfully to Zambia's development."

The mining sector is a major

pillar of Zambia's economy but many local suppliers face difficulty securing the capital needed to fulfill large procurement contracts. The MoU seeks to address those barriers by offering financing mechanisms tailored to suppliers' needs.

FQM said the agreement reaffirms its commitment to developing Zambian suppliers and increasing local participation through sustainable procurement and supplier development initiatives.

Eligible suppliers will be able to leverage FQM procurement opportunities while accessing FNB's business-banking, trade-finance and working-capital products, as well as enterprise growth support.

The collaboration aligns with national goals to boost local content, create employment, and build the capacity of Zambian-owned enterprises.

Nsama wins 4th ZLGU Order of Merit tourney at Konkola



By Benedict Tembo

The fourth Ladies Order of Merit tournament concluded on a high note at Konkola Golf Club in Chililabombwe at the weekend, drawing players from across the country in a vibrant display of elite competition and youth development successes.

Lusaka Golf Club's Annie Nsama emerged overall champion, securing top honours with an impressive 161 gross score.

Konkola's Lady Captain, Rachel May, mounted a strong challenge to finish runner-up with 165 gross.

Delivering her victory speech, Nsama shared a targeted message of encouragement with the rising talent in attendance, urging junior golfers across Zambia to remain disciplined, stay focused, and prioritize their education alongside athletic pursuits.

The tournament was sponsored by Konkola Copper Mines (KCM) through its Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) programme.

The company commended the Zambia Ladies Golf Union (ZLGU) for creating clear pathways for young golfers and praised the remarkable commitment of players who traveled long distances to compete.

Zambia Golf Union (ZLGU) President, Lorna Mwenda thanked KCM for its sponsorship and commended players nationwide for making the event a success.

Mwenda appealed for unity among women golfers, calling for strong participation in Order of Merit events across the country to sustain the momentum of the women's game.

Echoing these remarks, ZLGU vice president (North), Stella Gaviao, commended host Club captain James May and Lady captain Rachel May for their exceptional hospitality.

Gaviao urged Lady captains across all affiliate clubs to actively mobilise their membership for inter-club tournaments.

She said regular participation builds invaluable networks and drives long-term growth for women's golf.

Host club captain May expressed delight at the turnout, praising the participants' competitive spirit and confirming that Konkola Golf Club stands ready to host future national events.

Glasgow 'Club' Games contingent back with only 2 bronze medals

By Benedict Tembo

The Commonwealth Games Association of Zambia (CGA Zambia) has welcomed Team Zambia back home following an uninspiring campaign at the Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games in Scotland.

At the British Commonwealth games, Zambia secured two bronze medals through boxers Catherine Mwape and Emmanuel Katema, out of 22 athletes.

The delegation arrived at Kenneth Kaunda International Airport on Tuesday to a 'warm reception' led by National Olympic Committee and Commonwealth Games Association of Zambia vice-president Nakaonga Kakoma, NOCZ Treasurer Victor Banda, Deputy British High Commissioner to Zambia, Jason Tran and National Sports Council of Zambia Director Sombwa Musunsa.

Welcoming the team, Kakoma, in a message delivered on behalf of President Alfred Foloko, congratulated the athletes for representing Zambia on the Commonwealth stage.

According to NOCZ media, Foloko commended the athletes for their

dedication, discipline, and commitment throughout the Games.

He encouraged athletes that did not return home with medals not to be discouraged, as they remain national heroes whose efforts have inspired the country.

Bronze medallist Catherine Mwape, who made history as the first Zambian woman to win a Commonwealth Games boxing medal, said she travelled to Glasgow with one goal: to return home with a medal.

"My mission was to

come back home with a medal, whether bronze, silver, or gold. I am grateful to have achieved that goal. The experience has taught me a lot and has given me valuable exposure to compete against international boxers," Mwape said.

Fellow bronze medalist Emmanuel Katema described the Games as a valuable learning experience and thanked God for helping him achieve his dream of winning a Commonwealth Games medal.

"I thank God for this medal. The experience I

have gained is priceless, and now my focus shifts to preparing for future international competitions," Katema said.

Meanwhile, Team Zambia Head of Delegation Susanna Dakik said the delegation's objective had been to return home with medals, a mission that was successfully accomplished.

She commended all athletes for giving their best on the Commonwealth stage and thanked the coaches, support staff, government, stakeholders, and the Zambian people for

the encouragement and support shown throughout the Games.

The Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games saw Zambia represented by 22 athletes competing in five sports: athletics, boxing, judo, lawn bowls, and swimming. The performances delivered in Glasgow have provided a strong foundation as the country now turns its attention to future international competitions, including the 2027 Commonwealth Youth Games in Malta.

Mutapa named U-20 coach, tasked with AFCON qualification

By Benedict Tembo

The Football Association of Zambia (FAZ) has appointed Chipolopolo legend and Green Eagles coach Perry Mutapa as Under-20 men's football team coach.

Mutapa will be assisted by former Napsa Stars trainer Sipho Mumbi, Mufulira Wanderers gaffer Lameck Banda and Nkwazi coach Masautso Tembo as first, second and strikers' coaches respectively.

Other members of the technical bench are Mike Songwe Siame (goalkeepers coach), Donashano Malama (physical trainer) and Zani William Phiri (video Analyst). Team medics are Muyunda Mukubesa (doctor) and Abraham Banda (physiotherapist). With Joseph Chanda as the Security Manager: Team Ambassador: James Chamanga

Until recently, Mutapa, who was part of the Zambia Under-20 national team at the 1999 World Youth Cup in Nigeria, was an assistant coach at the senior men's team that participated at the 2025 Africa Cup of Nations in Morocco.

He takes over from Boyd Mulwanda whose last assignment was the 2025 Under-20 AFCON tournament in Egypt.

Former Chipolopolo defender Emmanuel Mbola and 2012 AFCON winner James Chamanga will serve as equipment manager and team ambassador in that order.

In a statement by FAZ head of media and communications Nkweto Tembwe,

FAZ General Secretary Charles Chakatazaya says the technical bench's immediate task would be preparations for next month's Africa Cup of Nations qualification tournament in Mauritius.

"In an effort to regenerate the focus for our

Under-20 boys' national team, we have decided to appoint a new bench to align with the assignments coming ahead. We have our focus on the forthcoming Africa Cup of Nations zonal qualifier which will take place in Mauritius from 18-27 September," Chakatazaya said.

"We have tasked the new bench to qualify the team to the AFCON and subsequently to the FIFA World Cup. Our Under-20 project has been on the wane since the 2017 side that won the AFCON and reached the quarterfinals of the FIFA World Cup in South Korea," he said.

Chakatazaya said FAZ was drawing from the coaching expertise of former internationals whom can inspire the current generation to aim for higher targets.

"The team assembled is bringing four former Chipolopolo stars whose experience we expect to spur the young lads to victory," Chakatazaya said.